CHRONIC CARE MANAGEMENT (CCM) COMPANY LAUNCH ROADMAP

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Building a remote Chronic Care Management services company for U.S. providers, operated from Pakistan

Working brand direction: Zenith Care Solutions / Zenith Health Partners

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This roadmap is a strategic starting reference, not legal, tax, or compliance advice. Confirm formation, licensing, and billing details with a qualified U.S. attorney, accountant, and compliance consultant before operating.

PART 1 — Understanding the CCM Business Model

Before building anything, one structural fact shapes the entire company: Medicare (CMS) pays only the **billing practitioner** — a U.S. physician, nurse practitioner, or physician assistant — for CCM services. Your company cannot bill Medicare directly. Instead, Zenith operates as a **subcontracted clinical staff provider**: the physician's practice bills Medicare using CCM CPT codes, and the practice pays your company for delivering the actual care coordination work "incident to" their supervision.

This is a well-established, proven model — it's exactly how companies such as ChartSpan and other CCM vendors operate. It is not a limitation on your business; it is simply the legal structure to build around.

Core CCM Billing Facts to Know Cold

- Patient must have **2 or more chronic conditions** expected to last 12+ months (hypertension, diabetes, COPD, chronic kidney disease, depression, arthritis, etc.)
- Patient must give **documented consent** to receive CCM services, recorded in their record
- Minimum **20 minutes of non-face-to-face clinical staff time per month** for base code **CPT 99490** (2026 Medicare reimbursement roughly $66 per patient/month)
- Add-on code **CPT 99439** covers additional 20-minute increments; **99487/99489** cover Complex CCM (60+ minutes, higher medical decision-making)
- **99491/99437** apply when the physician personally performs the time, rather than clinical staff
- No specific credentialing is mandated by CMS for CCM staff, but staff must be part of the clinical team, trained, and supervised by the billing physician — your Pharm D and clinical background is a genuine credential to lead with
- A documented **comprehensive care plan** (problem list, treatment goals, medication management, coordination with outside providers) must be maintained, typically inside the practice's EHR

Revenue framing to remember: a 200-patient CCM panel billing only the base code runs roughly $13,200/month in Medicare reimbursement for the practice — this is the number that gets a provider's attention.

PART 2 — Forming Your U.S. Company (Zenith): Full Detailed Steps

Non-U.S. residents can form and own a U.S. LLC — no visa, no SSN, and no U.S. address required to own the company. Below is every step, in order, with real costs and timelines.

Step 1 — Decide on Wyoming as your formation state

- Wyoming is recommended for you: lowest ongoing cost, no state income tax, strong owner privacy (members/managers are not listed on public filings), and it is well recognized by U.S. banks and healthcare clients as a normal, legitimate state of formation for a services company.
- Delaware is the alternative if you ever plan to raise outside investment — not necessary for a services business like Zenith at this stage.

- **Cost to know:** Wyoming Articles of Organization filing fee is $100 (about $102 if filed online with a small processing fee). Annual report after year one: minimum $60/year.

Step 2 — Choose and check your exact LLC name

- Decide the exact legal name, e.g. **"Zenith Care Solutions LLC"** — Wyoming requires the name to end in "LLC," "L.L.C.," or "Limited Liability Company."
- Search name availability directly on the Wyoming Secretary of State business search: **wyobiz.wyo.gov/Business/FilingSearch.aspx** — the name must be unique in the state.
- At the same time, check that the matching **.com** domain and the LinkedIn/Instagram company handle are available, so your legal name, domain, and social presence all match exactly.

Step 3 — Appoint your registered agent

- Required by law — a person or company with a physical Wyoming street address who receives legal and tax notices on your behalf. You cannot use your Pakistan address for this.
- As a non-resident, use a commercial registered agent service rather than trying to appoint yourself.
- **Cost:** roughly $25–$150/year depending on provider. Many formation services bundle year one free.
- Recommended providers: **Northwest Registered Agent** (northwestregisteredagent.com), **Wyoming Registered Agent** (wyomingregisteredagent.com).

Step 4 — File the Articles of Organization

- File directly with the Wyoming Secretary of State through the online WyoBiz portal, **wyobiz.wyo.gov**, or let a formation service file it for you.
- Information you'll need ready: LLC name, registered agent name and Wyoming address, your name and address as organizer/owner, principal business address (can be your Pakistan address or a virtual U.S. mailing address).
- **Cost:** $100 state filing fee. **Timeline:** approved same day to a few business days if filed online; 10–15 business days if filed by mail.
- **Recommended shortcut:** use a formation service so steps 2–5 are handled together in one package: **Northwest Registered Agent** (from $39 + state fee), **doola** (doola.com), **Firstbase** (firstbase.io), or **Stripe Atlas** (stripe.com/atlas). These are built specifically for non-resident founders and include registered agent + filing + EIN help in one bundle, typically $150–$400 total for year one.

Step 5 — Draft your LLC Operating Agreement

- An internal document establishing you as sole owner/manager, ownership percentage (100% to you), and how the company is run. Not filed with the state, but banks and future partners may ask to see it.
- Your formation service (Northwest, doola, Firstbase, Stripe Atlas) provides a standard single-member LLC operating agreement template as part of the package — use theirs rather than drafting from scratch.

Step 6 — Apply for your EIN (Employer Identification Number)

- This is your company's federal tax ID — required before you can open a U.S. bank account, sign client contracts, or receive payments.
- **Important:** as a non-resident without a U.S. Social Security Number, you cannot use the IRS's online EIN application. You must apply using **IRS Form SS-4** by phone, fax, or mail.
- **Phone (fastest for non-residents):** call the IRS international applicant line at **+1 (267) 941-1099** (not toll-free), Monday–Friday, 6am–11pm Eastern Time. Have your completed Form SS-4 in front of you when you call — the agent issues the EIN on the call.
- Form SS-4 is free and available at **irs.gov** (search "Form SS-4"). On the form, list yourself as the "responsible party" and mark that you have no SSN/ITIN.
- Most formation services (doola, Firstbase, Stripe Atlas) also offer EIN application assistance for a small fee, which can be worth it if you want to avoid the international call yourself.
- **Timeline:** immediate if done by phone; 4–8 weeks if done by fax or mail.

Step 7 — Open a U.S. business bank account

- You need this to receive client payments in USD and to keep business funds separate from personal funds.
- Non-resident-friendly options, roughly in order of ease for a Pakistan-based founder: **Mercury** (mercury.com — popular with non-resident LLC owners, free), **Wise Business** (wise.com — you likely already use personal Wise), **Payoneer** (payoneer.com — you already use this for the MTM business), **Relay** (relayfi.com).
- You will need: your EIN confirmation letter (IRS Form CP 575), Articles of Organization, and your passport.
- Apply only after your EIN is confirmed — most of these require it upfront.

Step 8 — Get a U.S. business phone number and mailing address

- A U.S. phone number builds trust with providers. Use **Google Voice** or **OpenPhone** (openphone.com) for a real U.S. number you can answer from Pakistan.
- A U.S. virtual mailing address (not required, but adds credibility on your website and contracts): **Anytime Mailbox** (anytimemailbox.com) or a service bundled with your formation provider.

Step 9 — Get professional liability (Errors & Omissions) insurance

- Once you're actively signing clients, healthcare practices will often ask for proof of liability insurance before contracting.
- U.S. providers for a remote/non-resident-owned LLC: **Next Insurance** (nextinsurance.com), **Hiscox** (hiscox.com). Get quotes once your LLC and EIN are in place.

Step 10 — Set up basic bookkeeping

- Even as a single-owner company, track income and expenses from day one — separate business and personal transactions completely.

- Simple options: a spreadsheet to start, or **Wave** (waveapps.com, free) or **QuickBooks Online** once revenue starts.

Total realistic startup cost for the LLC itself: roughly $250–$600 for filing, registered agent, and EIN help combined if you use a bundled formation service — plus $60/year ongoing for the Wyoming annual report.

PART 3 — Compliance Essentials: Step by Step

Step 1 — Understand your HIPAA obligations

- Even operating from Pakistan, any company that touches U.S. patient health information (names, diagnoses, care plans, contact details) is bound by HIPAA rules through its contract with the practice.
- This means: encrypted email/communication only (never plain email with patient names/details), secure login access to whatever EHR or CCM platform the practice uses, and a locked, access-controlled way of storing any notes.
- Practical tools: use the practice's own secure platform login rather than exporting patient data elsewhere; if you need internal notes, use a HIPAA-compliant tool such as **Google Workspace with a BAA** (available on paid plans) rather than personal Gmail.

Step 2 — Prepare a Business Associate Agreement (BAA) template

- A BAA is the contract that legally allows a practice to share patient data with Zenith. Every client practice must sign one before you touch any patient information.
- You do not need a lawyer to draft one from zero — standard, editable BAA templates are published by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services: search **"HHS sample Business Associate Agreement provisions"** at hhs.gov, or use a template bundled with a formation/compliance service such as doola or a healthcare compliance platform like **Compliancy Group** (compliancy-group.com).
- Have your attorney (or a service like Compliancy Group) review the template once before first use — worth the one-time cost given this is healthcare data.

Step 3 — Get familiar with common CCM software platforms

- You will typically work inside whatever platform the client practice already uses, so learn the landscape now: **ThoroughCare** (thoroughcare.net), **Prevounce** (prevounce.com), **CareHarmony** (careharmony.com), **ChartSpan** (chartspan.com).
- Many of these offer free demo videos or trial walkthroughs on their websites — go through at least two or three so you can speak knowledgeably when a provider asks "what platform do you use."

Step 4 — Set up secure internal systems before onboarding your first client

- Password manager for shared logins: **1Password** or **Bitwarden**.
- Encrypted file storage: Google Workspace or Microsoft 365 Business (both offer BAAs on paid healthcare-eligible plans).
- A simple internal log of which patients you've contacted, consent status, and time spent — this becomes essential once you're billing time to a practice.

PART 4 — Website & Professional Presence: Step by Step

Step 1 — Buy your domain

- Register the domain matching your legal name, e.g. **zenithcaresolutions.com**, through **Namecheap** (namecheap.com) or **Google Domains successor Squarespace Domains**. Cost: roughly $10–$15/year.

Step 2 — Choose a website builder and build the site

- Fastest options for a professional-looking site without coding: **Wix** (wix.com), **Squarespace** (squarespace.com), or **Webflow** (webflow.com) for more design control.
- Alternatively, since you've already used an AI website builder for PharmAbroad, the same approach works here and can be faster.
- Budget: roughly $15–$30/month for hosting on Wix/Squarespace.

Step 3 — Build these exact pages

- **Home:** headline stating what you do and who you serve — e.g. "Remote Chronic Care Management for U.S. Primary Care & Internal Medicine Practices" — plus a clear call-to-action button to book a call.
- **Services:** explain CCM in plain language, the monthly recurring revenue opportunity, and exactly what Zenith handles (patient outreach, care plan documentation, monthly time tracking).
- **About:** your credentials — Pharm D, clinical oncology/BMT background, hands-on CCM experience — this is your single biggest credibility asset, feature it prominently.
- **Compliance/Security:** a short, clear statement on HIPAA compliance and data handling.
- **Contact / Book a Call:** embed a **Calendly** (calendly.com, free tier) booking widget directly on the page so a provider can book a 15-minute call with zero back-and-forth email.

Step 4 — Set up a professional business email

- Use your domain for email, not Gmail — e.g. **ali@zenithcaresolutions.com**. Set this up through **Google Workspace** (workspace.google.com, about $6/user/month) or **Zoho Mail** (zoho.com/mail, free tier available).

Step 5 — Create your LinkedIn Company Page

- Set up a LinkedIn Company Page for Zenith matching your website branding exactly, and connect it to your personal LinkedIn profile as founder — providers will check both before responding to outreach.

PART 5 — Finding & Pitching Providers: Step by Step

Step 1 — Build your target list using the NPI Registry

- Go to **nppes.cms.hhs.gov** (the free NPI Registry search). Search by taxonomy/specialty ("Family Medicine," "Internal Medicine," "Geriatric Medicine") and by state.
- Start with 3–5 target states where Medicare Advantage penetration is high (e.g. Florida, Texas, Arizona, California) — these tend to have practices most receptive to CCM revenue conversations.
- Export or manually log: practice name, provider name, specialty, city/state, and any phone number listed.

Step 2 — Cross-reference with the CMS Data Portal

- At **data.cms.gov**, search Medicare provider utilization data to identify practices already serving a large Medicare patient panel — these are your highest-value targets since they have more eligible CCM patients.

Step 3 — Find the decision-maker's contact details

- Use **Apollo.io** (apollo.io, free tier gives limited monthly credits) to find verified email addresses for practice managers, office managers, and physicians at your target practices.
- Use **LinkedIn** search directly for the practice name plus "practice manager" or "office manager" — this role, not the physician directly, is often your best first contact.
- Use **Doximity** (doximity.com) to verify physician credentials and find a warmer path to direct physician contact if needed.

Step 4 — Build a simple tracking sheet

- Use Google Sheets with columns: Practice Name, Contact Name, Role, Email, LinkedIn, Phone, State, Specialty, Outreach Date, Follow-up Date, Status.
- Aim for an initial list of 100–150 targeted practices before starting outreach — this gives you enough volume to run a real campaign rather than reaching out one at a time.

Step 5 — Run a structured outreach cadence

- **Day 1:** send the initial email (template below) to the practice manager/decision-maker.
- **Day 4:** send a LinkedIn connection request with a short personalized note referencing the email.
- **Day 8:** send a brief follow-up email ("just following up on my note below — happy to answer any questions").
- **Day 12:** phone call to the front desk or practice manager, referencing the email and offering a quick 15-minute call.
- Track every touch in your sheet. Realistic expectation: a 5–10% response rate is normal for healthcare cold outreach, so plan volume accordingly.

Step 6 — Run the discovery call

- Keep it to 15 minutes. Structure: (1) confirm how many Medicare patients they see with 2+ chronic conditions, (2) explain the revenue math for their approximate panel size, (3) explain exactly what Zenith handles versus what stays with their staff, (4) propose next step — a simple service agreement and BAA to review.

Outreach Email Template

> **Subject:** Unbilled Medicare revenue your practice may be leaving on the table
>
> Hi Dr. [Last Name],
>
> I run Zenith Care Solutions, a Chronic Care Management (CCM) partner that helps primary care and internal medicine practices capture recurring Medicare reimbursement for the care coordination many patients already need — without adding staff workload to your office.
>
> For a practice with roughly 150–200 eligible Medicare patients, this typically represents $10,000–$13,000+ per month in reimbursement that's often not being billed.
>
> We handle the care coordination calls, documentation, and monthly time tracking directly, working inside whatever EHR or platform your practice already uses — your team stays focused on patient visits.
>
> Would you be open to a brief 15-minute call this week to see if it's a fit for your patient panel?
>
> Best regards,
> Ali Hassan Kaleem, PharmD
> Founder, Zenith Care Solutions
> [phone] | [email] | [website]

PART 6 — Full Launch Sequence, Week by Week

Week	Focus	Concrete Actions
1	Formation	Choose LLC name, check availability, order domain, hire registered agent, file Articles of Organiz
2	Formation + Banking	Apply for EIN via IRS phone line, sign operating agreement template, apply for U.S. business ba
3	Compliance	Prepare BAA template, review 2–3 CCM software platforms, set up Google Workspace email an
4	Website	Build website (Home, Services, About, Compliance, Contact/Calendly), set up LinkedIn Company
5	Lead list	Pull 100–150 target practices from NPI Registry + CMS Data Portal, enrich contacts via Apollo.io
6	Outreach begins	Send first batch of outreach emails (20–30/week is a sustainable pace), start LinkedIn follow-ups
7-8	Outreach + calls	Continue outreach cadence, take discovery calls as they book, send BAA + simple service agree

9-10	First onboarding	Sign first practice, complete BAA, get platform access/training, run first month of patient outreach
11+	Scale	Use first client as a case study/testimonial, expand outreach volume, consider adding part-time s

Detailed Onboarding Checklist for Your First Client (Once They Say Yes)

- Send the BAA for signature before any patient data is shared
- Send a simple service agreement covering: scope of work, monthly fee or per-patient fee structure, payment terms, termination clause
- Get platform access/login credentials to their EHR or CCM software
- Get a list of eligible patients (2+ chronic conditions, Medicare Part B) from the practice
- Confirm how patient consent will be obtained and documented (you may need to call patients directly to explain the program and get verbal/written consent, depending on the practice's preference)
- Set up your monthly workflow: patient outreach calls, care plan documentation, time tracking log, monthly summary report to the practice
- Schedule a recurring monthly check-in call with the practice to review results and address issues

Longer-Term: Expanding Beyond CCM

- Once you have 2-3 stable CCM clients and consistent cash flow, layer in adjacent services under the same Zenith brand: **medical billing**, **provider credentialing**, **medical coding**, and **Accounts Receivable (AR) follow-up** — all services the same practices already need.
- This is exactly why the broader "Zenith" brand name matters — none of these require a rebrand or a new website domain, only new service pages.

Appendix — Brand Name Options

Working direction: **Zenith** — meaning the highest point reached, the peak. Broad enough to grow from CCM into billing, coding, credentialing, and AR without a rebrand.

- **Zenith Care Solutions**
- **Zenith Health Partners**
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